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Systems and methods for configuring networking devices

Abstract

A method and system for configuring networking devices in a network having a local layer and a global layer. An indication of a network attack is received at the local layer. A configuration change corresponding to the attack is stored in a database of the local layer. The configuration change is sent to a device in the global layer. The device in the global layer stores the configuration change in a database of the global layer. Configuration changes are generated for the networking devices and sent to the networking devices. The configuration changes applied to the networking devices are stored in the global layer.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE

(1) The present application claims priority to EP application Ser. No. 23/305,390.9, filed Mar. 22, 2023, entitled “SYSTEMS AND METHODS FOR CONFIGURING NETWORKING DEVICES”, the entirety of which is incorporated herein by reference.

FIELD OF TECHNOLOGY

(2) The present technology relates to systems and methods for managing and/or modifying the configuration of networking devices.

BACKGROUND

(3) A network may include various networking devices for managing traffic within the network, such as routers, switches, firewalls, and/or other networking devices. The networking devices may come from different vendors, run different operating systems, have different roles, have different configurations, and/or otherwise be different from each other. In order to make a change to how the network routes or filters traffic, multiple networking devices may be reconfigured. Because of the

differences between these networking devices, a different configuration change may be performed on each of the different devices. Because of these differences it may be difficult and time consuming to make changes to a network with a large amount of networking devices.

(4) Due to the growing usage of cloud computing, more and more Internet services rely on cloud providers to ensure the availability of their services. Malicious attempts to disrupt a server, service or network are an ongoing threat against service availability. Denial of Service (DOS) attacks and Distributed Denial of Service (DDOS) attacks are ones of the most widespread types of attacks, against networks.

(5) A botnet including a large number of bots can be used to cause a DoS, DDOS, or other type of attack on a network. A DoS or DDOS attack causes the network to be flooded with superfluous requests. When under such an attack, the network may become so overloaded that services being hosted on the network might not be able to properly communicate with legitimate users and clients.

(6) Conventional mitigation solutions are slow to react to these types of attacks. Although some solutions have been shown to react within 30 seconds, this delay may actually exceed the duration of an attack, in which cases the mitigation is essentially fruitless.

(7) It is an object of the present technology to ameliorate at least some of the limitations present in the prior art.

SUMMARY

(8) Implementations of the present technology have been developed based on developers' appreciation of shortcomings associated with the prior art.

(9) According to a first broad aspect of the present technology, there is provided a method for configuring a plurality of networking devices in a network having a local layer and a global layer, the method comprising: receiving, at the local layer, an indication of a denial of service (DOS) attack directed at a system within the network; storing, in a database of the local layer, a configuration change corresponding to the DOS attack; sending, by a streamer device of the local layer and to a controller device of the global layer, the configuration change; storing, by the controller device, the configuration change in a database of the global layer, wherein the database of the global layer comprises stored configurations of the plurality of networking devices connected to the network; generating, by the controller device and based on the stored configurations in the database of the global layer, a plurality of configuration changes to send to the plurality of networking devices; storing, in the database of the global layer, the plurality of configuration changes; and sending, by the controller device of the global layer and to the plurality of networking devices, the plurality of configuration changes.

(10) In some implementations of the method, the method further comprises: determining that a configuration change of the plurality of configuration changes caused an error at a networking device of the plurality of networking devices; retrieving, by the controller device and from the database of the global layer, a prior configuration of the networking device; and causing, by controller device, the networking device to revert to the prior configuration.

(11) In some implementations of the method, the plurality of configuration changes comprise an address to add to a blacklist.

(12) In some implementations of the method, the plurality of configuration changes comprise profile updates for the plurality of networking devices.

(13) In some implementations of the method, the plurality of configuration changes cause incoming traffic corresponding to the address to be directed to one or more mitigation devices.

(14) In some implementations of the method, receiving the indication of the DOS attack comprises receiving user input indicating that a DOS attack is occurring.

(15) In some implementations of the method, the streamer is configured to send any changes that are made to the database of the local layer to the controller device of the global layer.

(16) In some implementations of the method, generating the plurality of configuration changes to send to the plurality of networking devices comprises, for each networking device of the plurality

of networking devices: retrieving, from the database of the global layer, a current configuration of the respective networking device, and determining, based on the current configuration of the respective networking device and based on the configuration change in the database of the global layer, a device-specific configuration change to be applied to the respective networking device.

(17) In some implementations of the method, sending the plurality of configuration changes to the plurality of networking devices comprises sending, to a plurality of drivers associated with the plurality of networking devices, the plurality of configuration changes.

(18) In some implementations of the method, the method further comprises applying, by the plurality of drivers, the plurality of configuration changes to the plurality of networking devices.

(19) According to another broad aspect of the present technology, there is provided a method for configuring a plurality of networking devices in a network having local layers and a global layer, the method comprising: detecting incoming traffic corresponding to a denial of service (DOS) attack directed at a system within the network; storing, by a controller device of the global layer, a configuration change in a database of the global layer, wherein the database of the global layer comprises stored configurations of the plurality of networking devices connected to the network; sending, by a streamer device of the global layer and to a controller devices of the local layers, the configuration change; generating, by the controller device of the global layer and based on the stored configurations in the database of the global layer, a plurality of configuration changes to send to the plurality of networking devices; storing, in the database of the global layer, the plurality of configuration changes; and sending, by the controller device of the global layer and to the plurality of networking devices, the plurality of configuration changes.

(20) In some implementations of the method, the method further comprises: determining that a configuration change of the plurality of configuration changes caused an error at a networking device of the plurality of networking devices; retrieving, by the controller device and from the database of the global layer, a prior configuration of the networking device; and causing, by controller device, the networking device to revert to the prior configuration.

(21) In some implementations of the method, the plurality of configuration changes comprise an address to add to a blacklist.

(22) In some implementations of the method, the plurality of configuration changes comprise profile updates for the plurality of networking devices.

(23) In some implementations of the method, the plurality of configuration changes cause incoming traffic corresponding to the address to be directed to one or more mitigation devices. In the context of the present specification, unless expressly provided otherwise, the expression “computer-readable medium” and “memory” are intended to include media of any nature and kind whatsoever, non-limiting examples of which include RAM, ROM, disks (CD-ROMs, DVDs, floppy disks, hard disk drives, etc.), USB keys, flash memory cards, solid state-drives, and tape drives.

(24) According to another broad aspect of the present technology, there is provided a method for configuring a plurality of networking devices in a network having a local layer and a global layer, the method comprising: storing, in a database of the local layer, a configuration change corresponding to the network; sending, by a streamer device of the local layer and to a controller device of the global layer, the configuration change; storing, by the controller device, the configuration change in a database of the global layer, wherein the database of the global layer comprises stored configurations of the plurality of networking devices connected to the network; generating, by the controller device and based on the stored configurations in the database of the global layer, a plurality of configuration changes to send to the plurality of networking devices; storing, in the database of the global layer, the plurality of configuration changes; and sending, by the controller device of the global layer and to the plurality of networking devices, the plurality of configuration changes.

(25) According to another broad aspect of the present technology, there is provided a system for network configuration, the system comprising a controller and a memory storing a plurality of

executable instructions which, when executed by the controller, cause the system to receive, at a local layer of the network, an indication of a denial of service (DOS) attack directed at a system within the network; storing, in a database of the local layer, a configuration change corresponding to the DOS attack; sending, by a streamer device of the local layer and to a controller device of a global layer, the configuration change; storing, by the controller device, the configuration change in a database of the global layer, wherein the database of the global layer comprises stored configurations of the plurality of networking devices connected to the network; generating, by the controller device and based on the stored configurations in the database of the global layer, a plurality of configuration changes to send to the plurality of networking devices; storing, in the database of the global layer, the plurality of configuration changes; and sending, by the controller device of the global layer and to the plurality of networking devices, the plurality of configuration changes.

(26) According to another broad aspect of the present technology, there is provided non-transitory computer-readable medium comprising computer-readable instructions that, upon being executed by a system, cause the system to receive, at a local layer of a network, an indication of a denial of service (DOS) attack directed at a system within the network; storing, in a database of the local layer, a configuration change corresponding to the DOS attack; sending, by a streamer device of the local layer and to a controller device of a global layer, the configuration change; storing, by the controller device, the configuration change in a database of the global layer, wherein the database of the global layer comprises stored configurations of the plurality of networking devices connected to the network; generating, by the controller device and based on the stored configurations in the database of the global layer, a plurality of configuration changes to send to the plurality of networking devices; storing, in the database of the global layer, the plurality of configuration changes; and sending, by the controller device of the global layer and to the plurality of networking devices, the plurality of configuration changes.

(27) In the context of the present specification, a “database” is any structured collection of data, irrespective of its particular structure, the database management software, or the computer hardware on which the data is stored, implemented or otherwise rendered available for use. A database may reside on the same hardware as the process that stores or makes use of the information stored in the database or it may reside on separate hardware, such as a dedicated server or plurality of servers.

(28) In the context of the present specification, unless expressly provided otherwise, the words “first”, “second”, “third”, etc. have been used as adjectives only for the purpose of allowing for distinction between the nouns that they modify from one another, and not for the purpose of describing any particular relationship between those nouns.

(29) Embodiments of the present technology each have at least one of the above-mentioned object and/or aspects, but do not necessarily have all of them. It should be understood that some aspects of the present technology that have resulted from attempting to attain the above-mentioned object may not satisfy this object and/or may satisfy other objects not specifically recited herein.

(30) Additional and/or alternative features, aspects and advantages of embodiments of the present technology will become apparent from the following description, the accompanying drawings and the appended claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) For a better understanding of the present technology, as well as other aspects and further features thereof, reference is made to the following description which is to be used in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, where:

- (2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of an example computing environment in accordance with various embodiments of the present technology;
- (3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of a network in accordance with various embodiments of the present technology;
- (4) FIG. 3 illustrates a flow of communications in the network in accordance with various embodiments of the present technology;
- (5) FIGS. 4 and 5 are a flow diagram of a method for configuring networking devices in accordance with various embodiments of the present technology.
- (6) It should be noted that, unless otherwise explicitly specified herein, the drawings are not to scale.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (7) The examples and conditional language recited herein are principally intended to aid the reader in understanding the principles of the present technology and not to limit its scope to such specifically recited examples and conditions. It will be appreciated that those skilled in the art may devise various arrangements which, although not explicitly described or shown herein, nonetheless embody the principles of the present technology and are included within its spirit and scope.
- (8) Furthermore, as an aid to understanding, the following description may describe relatively simplified implementations of the present technology. As persons skilled in the art would understand, various implementations of the present technology may be of a greater complexity.
- (9) In some cases, what are believed to be helpful examples of modifications to the present technology may also be set forth. This is done merely as an aid to understanding, and, again, not to define the scope or set forth the bounds of the present technology. These modifications are not an exhaustive list, and a person skilled in the art may make other modifications while nonetheless remaining within the scope of the present technology. Further, where no examples of modifications have been set forth, it should not be interpreted that no modifications are possible and/or that what is described is the sole manner of implementing that element of the present technology.
- (10) Moreover, all statements herein reciting principles, aspects, and/or implementations of the present technology, as well as specific examples thereof, are intended to encompass both structural and functional equivalents thereof, whether they are currently known or developed in the future. Thus, for example, it will be appreciated by those skilled in the art that any block diagrams herein represent conceptual views embodying the principles of the present technology. Similarly, it will be appreciated that any flowcharts, flow diagrams, state transition diagrams, pseudo-code, and the like represent various processes which may be substantially represented in computer-readable media and so executed by a computer or processor, whether or not such computer or processor is explicitly shown.
- (11) The functions of the various elements shown in the figures, including any functional block labeled as a “processor”, may be provided through the use of dedicated hardware as well as hardware capable of executing software in association with appropriate software. When provided by a processor, the functions may be provided by a single dedicated processor, by a single shared processor, or by a plurality of individual processors, some of which may be shared. In some implementations of the present technology, the processor may be a general purpose processor, such as a central processing unit (CPU) or a processor dedicated to a specific purpose, such as a digital signal processor (DSP) or quantum processing unit (QPU). Moreover, explicit use of the term a “processor” should not be construed to refer exclusively to hardware capable of executing software, and may implicitly include, without limitation, application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), field programmable gate array (FPGA), read-only memory (ROM) for storing software, random access memory (RAM), and non-volatile storage. Other hardware, conventional and/or custom, may also be included.
- (12) Software modules, or simply modules which are implied to be software, may be represented herein as any combination of flowchart elements or other elements indicating performance of

process steps and/or textual description. Such modules may be executed by hardware that is expressly or implicitly shown. Moreover, it should be understood that module may include for example, but without being limitative, computer program logic, computer program instructions, software, stack, firmware, hardware circuitry or a combination thereof.

(13) In the context of the present specification, unless expressly provided otherwise, a computer system may refer, but is not limited to, an “electronic device”, an “operation system”, a “system”, a “computer-based system”, a “controller unit”, a “monitoring device”, a “control device” and/or any combination thereof appropriate to the relevant task at hand.

(14) In the context of the present specification, unless expressly provided otherwise, the expression “computer-readable medium” and “memory” are intended to include media of any nature and kind whatsoever, non-limiting examples of which include RAM, ROM, disks (CD-ROMs, DVDs, floppy disks, hard disk drives, etc.), USB keys, flash memory cards, solid state-drives, and tape drives. Still in the context of the present specification, “a” computer-readable medium and “the” computer-readable medium should not be construed as being the same computer-readable medium. To the contrary, and whenever appropriate, “a” computer-readable medium and “the” computer-readable medium may also be construed as a first computer-readable medium and a second computer-readable medium.

(15) In the context of the present specification, unless expressly provided otherwise, the words “first”, “second”, “third”, etc. have been used as adjectives only for the purpose of allowing for distinction between the nouns that they modify from one another, and not for the purpose of describing any particular relationship between those nouns.

(16) In the context of the present disclosure, a Denial-of-Service (DOS) attack or Distributed Denial-of-Service (DDOS) attack refers to a malicious attack on a network, server, domain, and/or other target. A DDOS attack is a type of DOS attack in which numerous computers or machines flood a targeted resource.

(17) With these fundamentals in place, we will now consider some non-limiting examples of the present technology.

(18) Computing Environment

(19) FIG. 1 illustrates a computing environment **100**, which may be used to implement and/or execute any of the methods described herein. In some embodiments, the computing environment **100** may be implemented by any of a conventional personal computer, a network device and/or an electronic device (such as, but not limited to, a mobile device, a tablet device, a server, a controller unit, a control device, etc.), and/or any combination thereof appropriate to the relevant task at hand.

(20) In some embodiments, the computing environment **100** comprises various hardware components including one or more single or multi-core processors collectively represented by processor **110**, a solid-state drive **120**, a random access memory **130**, and an input/output interface **150**. The computing environment **100** may be a computer specifically designed to operate a machine learning algorithm (MLA). The computing environment **100** may be a generic computer system.

(21) In some embodiments, the computing environment **100** may also be a subsystem of one of the above-listed systems. In some other embodiments, the computing environment **100** may be an “off-the-shelf” generic computer system. In some embodiments, the computing environment **100** may also be distributed amongst multiple systems. The computing environment **100** may also be specifically dedicated to the implementation of the present technology. As a person in the art of the present technology may appreciate, multiple variations as to how the computing environment **100** is implemented may be envisioned without departing from the scope of the present technology.

(22) Those skilled in the art will appreciate that processor **110** is generally representative of a processing capability. In some embodiments, in place of or in addition to one or more conventional Central Processing Units (CPUs), one or more specialized processing cores may be provided. For example, one or more Graphic Processing Units **111** (GPUs), Quantum Processing Units (QPUs),

Tensor Processing Units (TPUs), and/or other so-called accelerated processors (or processing accelerators) may be provided in addition to or in place of one or more CPUs.

(23) System memory will typically include random access memory **130**, but is more generally intended to encompass any type of non-transitory system memory such as static random access memory (SRAM), dynamic random access memory (DRAM), synchronous DRAM (SDRAM), read-only memory (ROM), or a combination thereof. Solid-state drive **120** is shown as an example of a mass storage device, but more generally such mass storage may comprise any type of non-transitory storage device configured to store data, programs, and other information, and to make the data, programs, and other information accessible via a system bus **160**. For example, mass storage may comprise one or more of a solid state drive, hard disk drive, a magnetic disk drive, and/or an optical disk drive.

(24) Communication between the various components of the computing environment **100** may be enabled by a system bus **160** comprising one or more internal and/or external buses (e.g., a PCI bus, universal serial bus, IEEE 1394 “Firewire” bus, SCSI bus, Serial-ATA bus, ARINC bus, etc.), to which the various hardware components are electronically coupled.

(25) The input/output interface **150** may enable networking capabilities such as wired or wireless network communications. As an example, the input/output interface **150** may comprise a networking interface such as, but not limited to, a network port, a network socket, a network interface controller and the like. Multiple examples of how the networking interface may be implemented will become apparent to the person skilled in the art of the present technology. For example the networking interface may implement specific physical layer and data link layer standards such as Ethernet, Fibre Channel, Wi-Fi, Token Ring or Serial communication protocols. The specific physical layer and the data link layer may provide a base for a full network protocol stack, allowing communication among small groups of computers on the same local area network (LAN) and large-scale network communications through routable protocols, such as Internet Protocol (IP).

(26) The input/output interface **150** may be coupled to a touchscreen **190** and/or to the one or more internal and/or external buses **160**. The touchscreen **190** may be part of the display. In some embodiments, the touchscreen **190** is the display. The touchscreen **190** may equally be referred to as a screen **190**. In the embodiments illustrated in FIG. 1, the touchscreen **190** comprises touch hardware **194** (e.g., pressure-sensitive cells embedded in a layer of a display allowing detection of a physical interaction between a user and the display) and a touch input/output controller **192** allowing communication with the display interface **140** and/or the one or more internal and/or external buses **160**. In some embodiments, the input/output interface **150** may be connected to a keyboard (not shown), a mouse (not shown) or a trackpad (not shown) allowing the user to interact with the computing environment **100** in addition to or instead of the touchscreen **190**.

(27) According to some implementations of the present technology, the solid-state drive **120** stores program instructions suitable for being loaded into the random access memory **130** and executed by the processor **110** for executing acts of one or more methods described herein. For example, at least some of the program instructions may be part of a library or an application.

(28) Network with Local and Global Layers

(29) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of a network **201** in accordance with various embodiments of the present technology. The network **201** may include servers, networking devices such as switches, routers, and firewalls, storage systems, and/or other components. The devices of the network **201** may be located in a single physical location or may be in multiple physical locations. Portions of the network **201** may be housed in data centers that are each located in different physical locations.

(30) The network **201** may be organized in a virtual and/or physical manner. Devices of the network **201** may be organized into various “layers” which may or might not correspond to a physical location or geographical area. For example, all of the servers in a single datacenter may be grouped into a layer. In another example, all of the servers located in a single country may be

grouped into a layer, even if those servers are in different datacenters. Different types of devices may be grouped into different layers. For example, all networking devices of the network **201** may be grouped into a single layer.

(31) The network **201** includes a local layer **210**, local layer **220**, global layer **230**, and networking devices **240**. It should be understood that the network may have any configuration, such as any number of layers, devices, etc.

(32) The local layer **210** may include a user interface **211**, store device **212**, local database **213**, streamer device **214**, and/or any other type of device that can communicate in a network. Although illustrated as separate devices, the user interface **211**, store device **212**, local database **213**, and/or streamer device **214** may be implemented on any number of devices, may be implemented on a same device, and/or may be implemented as applications executing on one or more devices. The user interface **211**, store device **212**, local database **213**, and/or streamer device **214** may be components of a microservice architecture.

(33) The user interface **211** may be accessed by a user of the network **201**, client of the network **201**, administrator of the network **201**, and/or any other authorized individual. The user interface **211** may be used to configure various aspects of the network **201**. A client who is hosting a service in the local layer **210** may access the user interface **211** to administer the service. The client may be able to configure how traffic is routed through the network **201** to the service, how the service is executed within the network **201**, and/or configure any other aspect of the service.

(34) The user interface **211** may be accessed to indicate that an attack is expected and/or occurring on the network **201**. The attack may be a DOS attack and/or any other type of attack. A user may select, via the user interface **211**, which servers, services, network customers, etc. are believed to be affected by the attack. A user may input, via the user interface **211**, a request to block certain traffic and/or direct the traffic to the mitigation devices **250**. The user may input one or more rules for identifying traffic to be blocked or directed to the mitigation devices **250**. For example, a user may indicate an external IP address and request that all traffic from that IP address be blocked. In another example, a user may indicate a group of servers within the network **201** and request that all traffic directed to those servers be sent to the mitigation devices **250**. The user may input rules that are to be executed after an attack is detected. For example the user may indicate that, upon detection of an attack on the network **201**, traffic directed to a specified address or service should be redirected to a mitigation device.

(35) The store device **212** may write to and read from the local database **213**. The local database **213** may store data for the local layer **210**, such as information about the devices within the local layer **210**, devices associated with the local layer **210** services provided by devices within the local layer **210**, accounts associated with the local layer **210**, and/or any other data regarding the local layer **210** and/or network **201**. The local database **213** may contain configuration information for some or all of the devices in the local layer **210** and/or devices associated with the local layer **210**. For example, firewall devices may be associated with the local layer **210**. Any traffic directed at the devices within the local layer **210** may first pass through these firewalls.

(36) The configuration information stored in the local database **213** may contain, for each device in the local layer **210**, a current configuration of the device and/or a record of all changes made to the configuration of the device. Each change may include a version number, timestamp, and/or any other versioning information. The local database **213** may be any type of database, such as a MongoDB database.

(37) The store device **212** may generate a rule based on input received from the user interface **211** and store the rule in the local database **213**. For example, a rule may be generated that indicates that all traffic from a specified IP address should be blocked. The rule may then be applied to networking devices by a controller device, such as a controller device in the local layer **210** (not illustrated) or a controller device **231** in the global layer **230**.

(38) The streamer device **214** may communicate with the controller device **231** in the global layer

230. The streamer device **214** may send any changes that occur in the local database **213** to the controller device **231**. After a rule is stored in the local database **213**, or any other change is made to the local database **213** the streamer device **214** may transmit that change to the controller device **231**. Any changes to the local layer **210** may be transmitted to the global layer **230**.

(39) Initially, the streamer device **214** may transmit the entire contents of the local database **213** to the controller device **231**. After the contents of the local database **213** have been transmitted to the controller device **231**, the streamer device **214** may follow any changes to the local database **213** and forward those changes to the controller device **231**.

(40) The local layer **220** may be similar to the local layer **210**. The local layer **220** may have a user interface **221**, store device **222**, streamer device **224**, and local database **223**. Like in the local layer **210**, the streamer device **224** of the local layer **220** may transmit the contents of the local database **223** to the controller device **231** of the global layer. Any changes to the local database **223** may be transmitted by the streamer device **224** to the controller device **231**. In this manner the controller device **231** of the global layer **230** may receive an indication of every configuration change made within the local layers **210** and **220** of the network **201**. The local layer **210** and the local layer **220** may be associated with different geographic areas. For example the local layer **210** may correspond to North America, and the local layer **220** may correspond to Europe.

(41) The global layer **230** may contain devices that manage the entire network **201**. The global layer **230** may include the controller device **231**, a user interface **235**, a store device **236**, a global database **237**, and/or a streamer device **238**. Although FIG. 2 illustrates a single global layer **230**, the network **201** may include multiple global layers. The network **201** may include any hierarchy of layers.

(42) The controller device **231** may contain a store **232**, database **233**, and/or streamer **234**. The controller device **231** may receive updates that occur at any databases of the local layers of the network **201**, such as updates to the local database **213** and/or local database **223**. The controller device **231** may store this information in the database **233** of the controller device **231**. The database **233** may contain a copy of each of the local databases of the network **201**. The database **233** may also include a record of changes to the local databases of the network **201**.

(43) The store **232** may write to and read from the database **233**. The database **233** may store a configuration of some or all of the devices in the network **201**. The database **233** may act as a cache, storing a copy of the whole configuration of each of the networking devices **240** that can be sent to any of the networking devices **240** that requests it. Even if part of the network **201** is offline and/or otherwise inaccessible, a networking device **240** can still retrieve its configuration from the controller device **231** because the configuration is stored in the database **233**. The database **233** may store a record of changes made to the configurations of the devices in the network **201**, such as a record of any rules that are sent to the devices in the network **201**.

(44) The user interface **235** may be similar to the user interface **211**, except that it is used for indicating changes to the global layer **230** rather than a local layer. The user interface **235** may be used to input information related to an attack on the network **201** and/or a request for any other configuration change for the network **201**. The input received by the user interface **235** may be sent to the store device **236**. The store device **236** may write to and read from the global database **237**. The global database **237** may store global data for the network **201**, such as global configuration data.

(45) The controller device **231** may subscribe to the global database **237**. Anytime a change occurs at the global database **237**, the streamer device **238** may send the change to the controller device **231**. The local database **213**, local database **223**, and global database **230** may be any type of database, such as a MongoDB database.

(46) After receiving an indication of a change to the local database **213**, local database **223**, and/or any other database or device in the network, the controller device **231** may determine that a configuration change is to be made to some or all of the networking devices **240** in the network

201. The streamer **234** of the controller device **231** may send a configuration change to a networking device **241**, networking device **245**, mitigation devices **250**, and/or any of the other networking devices **240**.

(47) In order to send a configuration change to the networking device **241**, the controller device **231** may retrieve a current configuration of the networking device **241** from the global database **237**. The controller device **231** may then determine, based on the current configuration of the networking device **241**, a configuration change to be applied to the networking device **241**. The configuration change may apply a rule to the networking device **241**.

(48) After generating a configuration change for the networking device **241**, the streamer **234** may send the configuration change to the networking device **241**.

(49) The controller device **231** may store the updated configuration of the networking device **241** to the global database **237**. The controller device **231** may store an indication of each change that has been made to the networking device **241**. The controller device **231** may be able to roll back any configuration changes that were made to the networking device **241**. If a configuration change made to the networking device **241** causes an error to occur, the controller device **231** may cause the networking device **241** to revert to a prior configuration.

(50) The controller device **231** may be able to check the integrity of any of the networking devices **240**, such as any of the mitigation devices **250**. In order to check the integrity of a mitigation device **250**, the controller device **231** may retrieve the configuration of the mitigation device **250** that is stored in the global database **237**. The controller device **231** may compare the configuration stored in the global database **237** to the actual configuration of the mitigation device **250**. If the stored configuration does not match the actual configuration, an error may be reported. The networking device **241** may be reconfigured so that its configuration matches the stored configuration in the global database **237**.

(51) Similar to how the configuration of the networking device **241** is updated, the controller device **231** may retrieve a configuration of the networking device **245**, receive a configuration change to be applied to the networking device **245**, and send the configuration change to the networking device **245**.

(52) The controller device **231** may retrieve a current configuration of the mitigation devices **250**. The controller device may determine, based on the current configuration of the mitigation devices **250**, a configuration change to be applied to the mitigation devices **250**. The controller device **231** may send the configuration change to the mitigation devices **250**, and the mitigation devices **250** may apply the configuration changes. A driver **251** of the mitigation device **250** may push the configuration onto a dataplane of the mitigation device **250**.

(53) The configuration changes sent to the networking device **241**, networking device **245**, and/or mitigation devices **250** may include a rule or any other instructions for routing traffic through the network **201**. The configuration changes may include addresses, such as IP addresses, to be added and/or removed from a blacklist. The blacklist may indicate that any packets received from the addresses on the blacklist are to be dropped. The configuration change may include a rule indicating types of traffic that are to be sent to the mitigation devices **250**. The configuration changes may include profile updates for the plurality of networking devices **240**.

(54) The local layer **210** and/or local layer **220** may each contain a controller device (not illustrated). The controller device of the local layers **210** and/or **220** may have a same or similar configuration as the controller device **231**. The controller device of the local layers **210** and/or **220** may configure networking devices of the respective local layer, such as networking devices that are exclusively associated with the respective local layer.

(55) FIG. 3 illustrates a flow of communications in the network **201** in accordance with various embodiments of the present technology. It should be understood that the communication flow illustrated in FIG. 3 is exemplary, and that the illustrated devices may communicate with each other in any manner. Each of the communication links illustrated in FIG. 3 may be bi-directional.

(56) Incoming traffic **310** may originate from outside the network **201**. Other incoming traffic (not illustrated) may originate within the network **201**. The incoming traffic **310** may be any request received from outside of the network. The incoming traffic **310** may include a request to access a web site or other web resource (such as an HTTP GET request), a request to access a cloud service, and/or any other type of request. The request may include a domain name, destination address of a server or service within the network **201**, port number, a request type, and/or any other information regarding the request.

(57) The incoming traffic **310** may include traffic related to an attack on the network **201** or an attack on a server or service within the network **201**. For example, during a DDOS attack, the incoming traffic **310** may include a large volume of requests from compromised devices. The traffic from the compromised devices may be directed at a service or domain hosted by servers within the network **201**.

(58) The incoming traffic **310** may be received by networking devices **240**. The networking devices **240** may include firewalls, routers, switches, and/or any other type of networking devices. The networking devices **240** may route the incoming traffic **310** through the network **201** to the servers **320**. When a packet from the incoming traffic **310** is received by the networking devices **240**, the networking devices **240** may determine, based on information within the packet, which of the servers **320** the packet should be routed to. The networking devices **240** may then route the packet to the proper server of the servers **320**.

(59) An attack detection device **315** may monitor the incoming traffic **310** to detect an attack. The attack detection device **315** may watch for increases in the volume of incoming traffic **310**, patterns in the incoming traffic **310** that resemble an attack, and/or may otherwise detect an attack in the incoming traffic **310**. After detecting an attack, the attack detection device **315** may send an indication that an attack is occurring to a store device, such as one of the local layer store devices **212** and **222**, or the global layer store device **236**. The indication of the attack may then be stored in the corresponding database and forwarded to the controller device **231** by the corresponding streamer device. The indication may include details about where the attack is originating, what type of attack has been detected, the target of the attack, and/or any other information regarding the attack.

(60) As described above, the streamer device **214**, or any other streamer device within the network **201**, may inform the controller device **231** of an attack and/or any other configuration change to be made to the network **201**. The streamer device **214** may send a database update to the controller device **231** indicating that a configuration change is to be made to the network **201**.

(61) The controller device **231** may receive an indication of a configuration change to be made to the network **201** from the attack detection device **315**, streamer device **214**, and/or any other device within or outside of the network **201**. The configuration change may be to respond to an attack, to anticipate a future attack, to adjust the network when an IP address is assigned to a new service, and/or for any other reason. As described above, the controller device **231** may determine configuration changes to send to the networking device **240**.

(62) The configuration changes from the controller device **231** may cause some of the traffic received by the networking devices **240** to be sent to the mitigation devices **250**, rather than directly to the servers **320**. The configuration changes may provide rules for identifying traffic to be sent to the mitigation devices **250**. The configuration changes may include a rule to send any traffic originating from specified addresses, networks, geographic locations, etc. to the mitigation devices **250**. The configuration changes may include a rule to send traffic that is directed to specified services, servers, domains, etc. to the mitigation devices **250**. The rules may specify that the traffic affected by the rule is to be sent to the mitigation devices **250** or is to be blocked. If the traffic is blocked, those packets may be discarded by the networking devices **240** rather than being forwarded to other devices in the network **201**. The networking devices **240** may contain a blacklist of addresses, where any traffic from addresses on the blacklist may be blocked.

(63) Method for Configuring Networking Devices

(64) FIGS. 4 and 5 are a flow diagram of a method **400** for configuring networking devices in accordance with various embodiments of the present technology. All or portions of the method **400** may be executed by any of the devices illustrated in FIGS. 2 and 3, such as a store device, streamer device, database, controller device, networking device, mitigation device, and/or any other type of device in the network **201**. In one or more aspects, the method **400** or one or more steps thereof may be performed by a computing system, such as the computing environment **100**. The method **400** or one or more steps thereof may be embodied in computer-executable instructions that are stored in a computer-readable medium, such as a non-transitory mass storage device, loaded into memory and executed by a CPU. The method **400** is exemplary, and it should be understood that some steps or portions of steps in the flow diagram may be omitted and/or changed in order.

(65) At step **405** an indication of a DOS attack, DDOS attack, any other type of attack, or a network configuration change may be received. The attack may be detected, such as by the attack detection device **315**. The indication of the attack, or other configuration change, may be input by a user, such as via the user interface **211** or user interface **221**. The indication of the attack may include details about the attack, such as a target of the attack, identification of the attacker, the type of attack, and/or any other details about the attack. The network configuration change may indicate a desired configuration change to the network, such as adding an address to a blacklist, changing how traffic is routed within the network, placing a server online or offline, and/or any other change to a network.

(66) At step **410** a rule and/or other configuration change may be determined for responding to the attack. A mitigation profile may have been previously defined. The mitigation profile may indicate actions to be taken after an attack is detected, such as the rules and/or other configuration changes to be applied in response to an attack. The mitigation profile may be linked to services and/or addresses. The mitigation profile may cause traffic to the specified services and/or addresses to be re-routed after detecting an attack. The rule may be an instruction to block or redirect certain incoming traffic. Incoming packets may be filtered based on a source address, destination address, and/or any other feature of the packets. The packets that are filtered out may be directed to a mitigation device, may be blocked, discarded, may be further analyzed, and/or otherwise managed. The configuration change may be a global change to be applied to the entire network, and/or a local change to be applied to a specific layer of the network, such as the local layer **210** or local layer **220**.

(67) At step **415** the rule and/or other configuration change may be stored in a local database. A record of the rule may be stored in the local database, such as by the store device **212** or store device **222**. A verification may be performed to ensure that the rule and/or other configuration change is consistent with the configuration rules of the corresponding layer. Rules corresponding to an individual user/customer may be isolated from impacting other users/customers and/or global settings for the network.

(68) At step **420** the rule and/or other configuration change may be sent to a controller device. A streamer device, such as the streamer device **214** or streamer device **224**, may be subscribed to the local database. The local database may send an indication to the streamer device of any changes made to the local database. The streamer device may send an indication to the controller device of the changes to the local database. The changes to the local database may include an indication of the rule or other configuration change that was stored at step **415**.

(69) At step **425** the rule and/or other configuration change may be stored in a global database. The global database may be part of the global layer of the network. The global database may store a configuration of all networking devices within the network. The rule and/or other configuration change may be stored in the global database by a controller device of the global layer, such as the controller device **231**.

(70) Steps **405-25** describe how a rule is received at a local layer and then stored at a global layer

of the network. A rule may be received at the global layer, rather than the local layer. For example an attack detection device **315** may detect an attack and store a rule in the global database **237** to respond to the attack. The new rule stored in the global database may then be sent to any local databases of regions affected by the rule. The controller device **231** may detect the change to the global database **237**, identify which local layers are affected by the change, and then send the change to the streamer devices of any local layers affected by the change.

(71) At step **430** networking devices affected by the rule and/or other configuration change may be identified. The rule and/or other configuration change may indicate a change to be made to the network. In order to implement the rule and/or other configuration change, some or all of the networking devices in the network may be modified. The networking devices to be modified to implement the rule and/or other configuration change may be identified. For example if the rule and/or other configuration change applies to a specific layer of the network, all of the networking devices that manage traffic for that layer of the network may be identified, so that those networking devices can be reconfigured in order to implement the rule and/or other configuration change. The identified networking devices may include firewalls, routers, switches, mitigation devices, and/or any other type of networking devices.

(72) At step **435** instructions may be generated for each of the networking devices identified at step **430**. The instructions may be device-specific instructions for applying the rule and/or other configuration change to the device. The instructions may instruct the networking devices to apply the rule, apply a configuration change, add or remove an address from a blacklist, apply a new device profile, and/or any other type of instructions. A current device configuration may be retrieved from the global database for each of the devices identified at step **430**. Using the current configuration of the devices, an instruction may be generated for each device in order to implement the rule and/or other configuration change. The instructions may be in any format that can be executed by the networking devices. The instructions may be in a Remote Procedure Call (RPC) format, such as GRPC.

(73) At step **440** the instructions may be sent to the networking devices. The instructions may be sent by a controller device, such as the controller device **231**, to the networking devices. The networking devices may then apply the rule and/or other configuration change in the instructions to their drivers. Using the steps described herein, a large number of networking devices can be rapidly reconfigured. For example thousands of networking devices may be reconfigured within seconds to respond to an attack on the network.

(74) At step **445** the networking devices may transmit a confirmation that the instructions were executed. The networking devices may transmit the confirmations to a controller device.

(75) At step **450** the updated configurations of the networking devices may be stored in the global database. The controller device may store an indication in the global database of the updated configurations of the networking devices. Each change made to the networking devices may be stored in the global database. Previous configurations of the networking devices may be stored in the global database. The global database may implement versioning. Each change to a configuration may be stored in the database with a version number, timestamp, and/or any other indication of a version corresponding to the change. The database may form a changelog indicating all configuration changes that have been made to each of the networking devices. The changelog may be used for traceability, accounting, and/or rolling back devices to previous configurations.

(76) At step **455** a determination may be made as to whether the instructions have caused any errors. Errors may be detected at individual devices and/or for the entire network. An error may be detected if a device is malfunctioning, if packets are not being routed correctly, etc. The integrity of a networking device may be determined by comparing a current configuration of the networking device with the configuration of the networking device that is stored in the global database. If the current configuration of the networking device does not match the configuration of the networking device that is stored in the global database, an error may be detected and the method **400** may

proceed to step **460**. If no errors are detected at step **455**, the method **400** may end. If an error is detected at step **455**, the method may continue to step **460** to address the error.

(77) At step **460** the networking devices experiencing errors and/or affected by errors may be identified. The configuration changes to these devices may be reverted in order to address the error. Rather than identifying networking devices affected by errors, all of the networking devices identified at step **430** may be reverted to their prior configuration. By reverting all of the networking devices to a prior configuration, the rule and/or other configuration change that was applied to the networking devices may be removed.

(78) At step **465** the networking devices identified at step **460** may be reverted to a prior configuration. For each device, an instruction may be generated that reverts the device to a prior configuration. To generate the instruction for a device, the instruction that was sent to the device at step **440** may be retrieved. Then, an instruction that reverses the effects of that prior instruction may be generated and sent to the device. A previous version of the networking device's configuration may be retrieved based on the version number. The configuration with the prior version number may then be applied to the networking device.

(79) At step **470** an indication may be stored in the global database indicating that the networking devices were reverted to the prior configuration. A current configuration of the networking devices stored in the database may be updated to indicate that the networking devices were reverted to the prior configuration. After updating the database, the method **400** may end.

(80) While some of the above-described implementations may have been described and shown with reference to particular acts performed in a particular order, it will be understood that these acts may be combined, sub-divided, or re-ordered without departing from the teachings of the present technology. At least some of the acts may be executed in parallel or in series. Accordingly, the order and grouping of the act is not a limitation of the present technology.

(81) It should be expressly understood that not all technical effects mentioned herein need be enjoyed in each and every embodiment of the present technology.

(82) As used herein, the wording “and/or” is intended to represent an inclusive-or; for example, “X and/or Y” is intended to mean X or Y or both. As a further example, “X, Y, and/or Z” is intended to mean X or Y or Z or any combination thereof.

(83) The foregoing description is intended to be exemplary rather than limiting. Modifications and improvements to the above-described implementations of the present technology may be apparent to those skilled in the art.

Claims

1. A method for configuring a plurality of networking devices in a network having a local layer and a global layer, the method comprising: receiving, at the local layer, an indication of a denial of service (DOS) attack directed at a system within the network; storing, in a database of the local layer, a configuration change corresponding to the DOS attack; sending, by a streamer device of the local layer and to a controller device of the global layer, the configuration change; storing, by the controller device, the configuration change in a database of the global layer, wherein the database of the global layer comprises stored configurations of the plurality of networking devices connected to the network; generating, by the controller device and based on the stored configurations in the database of the global layer, a plurality of configuration changes to send to the plurality of networking devices; storing, in the database of the global layer, the plurality of configuration changes; and sending, by the controller device of the global layer and to the plurality of networking devices, the plurality of configuration changes.

2. The method of claim 1, further comprising: determining that a configuration change of the plurality of configuration changes caused an error at a networking device of the plurality of networking devices; retrieving, by the controller device and from the database of the global layer, a

prior configuration of the networking device; and causing, by controller device, the networking device to revert to the prior configuration.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein the plurality of configuration changes comprise an address to add to a blacklist.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein the plurality of configuration changes comprise profile updates for the plurality of networking devices.

5. The method of claim 3, wherein the plurality of configuration changes cause incoming traffic corresponding to the address to be directed to one or more mitigation devices.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein receiving the indication of the DOS attack comprises receiving user input indicating that a DOS attack is occurring.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein the streamer device is configured to send any changes that are made to the database of the local layer to the controller device of the global layer.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein generating the plurality of configuration changes to send to the plurality of networking devices comprises, for each networking device of the plurality of networking devices: retrieving, from the database of the global layer, a current configuration of the respective networking device; and determining, based on the current configuration of the respective networking device and based on the configuration change in the database of the global layer, a device-specific configuration change to be applied to the respective networking device.

9. The method of claim 1, wherein sending the plurality of configuration changes to the plurality of networking devices comprises sending, to a plurality of drivers associated with the plurality of networking devices, the plurality of configuration changes.

10. The method of claim 9, further comprising applying, by the plurality of drivers, the plurality of configuration changes to the plurality of networking devices.

11. A system for network configuration, the system comprising a controller and a memory storing a plurality of executable instructions which, when executed by the controller, cause the system to perform the method of claim 1.

12. A non-transitory computer-readable medium comprising computer-readable instructions that, upon being executed by a system, cause the system to perform method of claim 1.
